

MnM Party Meter

Purpose, setup, accuracy, and beta-testing guide

External OCR-based party damage meter for Monsters & Memories



WHY THIS EXISTS

MnM Party Meter was built to make damage progression easier to understand while playing with friends - from fresh-server characters with little gear through later levels, spells, weapons, and equipment.

It is not intended to shame players or turn every encounter into a competition. Damage is one piece of gameplay data, and comparisons are most useful when level, gear, encounter length, target selection, group composition, and player role are considered.

Why I made it

The main goal is to understand damage across different parts of the game, not just one perfect parse.

QUESTIONS THIS TOOL CAN HELP ANSWER

- How do classes look on a fresh server with little gear?
- How does damage change as players gain levels, spells, weapons, and items?
- What happens to party damage in early, mid, and later progression?
- How much output comes from pets, dots, procs, or burst windows?
- How does a class perform in different party positions and encounter types?

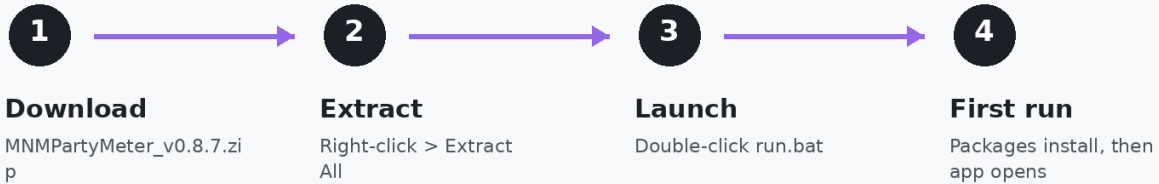
WHY EARLY-SERVER PROGRESSION MATTERS

The early part of a server tells you a lot. Everyone has less gear, fewer tools, and more uneven access to upgrades. That makes it useful for seeing how classes begin to separate - and how quickly those differences change.

A single number is never the whole story. Treat the meter as a record of a particular group, place, level range, and moment in progression.

Install the meter

The release package is designed so friends do not need to assemble the Python environment manually.



Planned standalone build: one setup.exe will replace the ZIP / run.bat / separate Python + Tesseract steps.

INSTALLATION

1. Extract the downloaded MnM Party Meter release ZIP.
2. Run INSTALL - START HERE.cmd.
3. Allow the installer to prepare the application environment. If a compatible Tesseract installation already exists, it can be reused.
4. Launch MnM Party Meter from the desktop shortcut.
5. Keep Monsters & Memories on the monitor containing the combat windows you plan to capture.

UPDATING

Close the meter, extract the newer release, and run the installer over the existing installation. You should not need to uninstall Python, Tesseract, or the previous meter version.

Why the meter uses two combat windows



RECOMMENDED LAYOUT

- OTHER: outgoing damage from the rest of the party.
- MY: your outgoing damage and your pet's outgoing damage.
- Keep the two windows near each other so one OCR capture rectangle can cover both.
- They do not need to be the same size or scroll at the same speed.

WHY SPLIT THEM?

A single combat window containing an entire party's damage can scroll extremely quickly. Separating your own damage from the rest of the party reduces how much text each window must carry and gives OCR more opportunities to see a line before it leaves the screen.

In a full party, Other will usually move much faster than My. That is expected. Different scroll speeds do not inherently create duplicate damage events.

The windows do not need to sit in an exact location. What matters is that both combat windows remain visible and close enough to fit inside one selected OCR region.

Designate the screen space for combat data

Use one OCR capture region around the complete Other/My combat windows.



The yellow OCR box begins above Other and ends below the FULL My window.

WHAT THE OCR SELECTION MUST COVER

The selected region must include the entire readable text area of BOTH panes. In the example above, you can see all four yellow edges of one single capture rectangle: top, left, right, and bottom.

Do not stop the selection at the boundary between Other and My. Other and My can scroll at different speeds; they simply need to stay close enough to fit inside one OCR region.

Configure players, pets, and charm targets

MnM Party Meter - Setup

Enter party members and named pets, then select both combat windows as one OCR region.

#	Name	Class	Pet name(s)
1	Prussy	Enchanter	
2	Redball	Shaman	
3	Alden	Elementalist	Zzugli
4		Shadowknight	
5		Necromancer	
6		Beastmaster	

Your character name OCR refresh

1 Select BOTH combat windows

2 Start OCR

Show OCR diagnostics

Named pets: If a pet appears in combat under its own name, enter that name beside its owner.

Multiple pets: Separate names with commas.

PARTY SETUP

1. Enter party members

Add the characters you want tracked and select each class.

2. Add named pets

If a pet appears in combat under its own name, enter that exact name in the owner's Pet name(s) field. Multiple aliases can be comma-separated.

3. Charmed pets

For Enchanter or Bard charm, use an atypical target when possible: charm something your party is not also actively fighting, then enter that creature's name as the player's pet name.

4. Set your character name

The meter uses this to associate Your / You combat lines with the correct player.

CHARM TIP

If the party is fighting several creatures with the same name as the charmed pet, visible combat text may not contain enough information to distinguish the friendly charm from hostile creatures reliably.

OCR refresh, duplicates, and reset behavior

WHAT OCR IS

OCR means Optical Character Recognition. The meter repeatedly captures the selected screen region and uses Tesseract to turn the visible combat-log pixels into text that the parser can recognize.

Because the meter is reading the screen rather than receiving a structured combat log, recognition can occasionally miss or misread a line - especially when text scrolls very quickly.

300 MS DOES NOT MEAN THE SAME LINE IS COUNTED EVERY 300 MS

300 ms is the recommended starting refresh rate. The meter compares newly recognized text against recent frames and events so that a line remaining visible across multiple captures is not intended to be counted repeatedly.

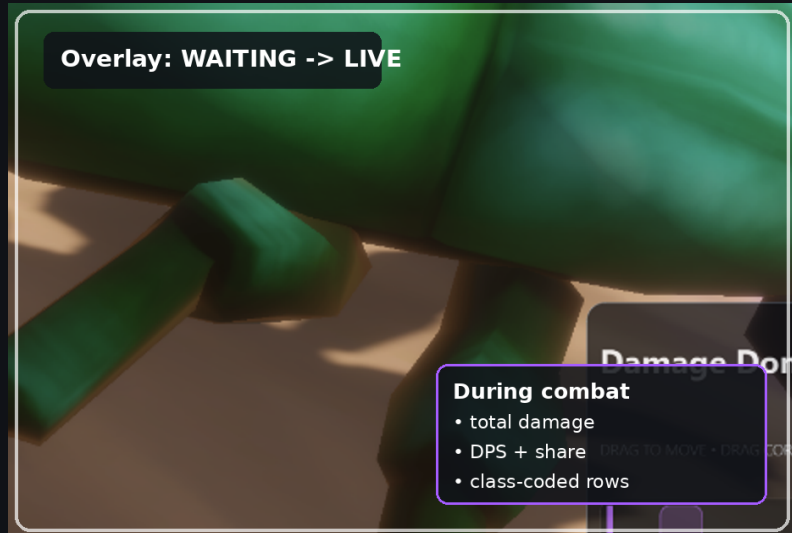
RESET SAFELY - EVEN WHEN OLD TEXT IS STILL VISIBLE

Reset clears the encounter totals, timer, and duplicate/event history. The next complete OCR reading of Other + My becomes a new baseline.

Everything already visible at that moment is treated as old combat text and ignored. Only newly appearing damage lines should contribute to the new encounter.

This means you do not need to physically clear the MnM combat windows before starting a new encounter.

Read the overlay and use the data well



WHAT THE OVERLAY SHOWS

- Party ranking by total outgoing damage.
- Total damage, approximate DPS, and share of recognized party damage.
- Class labels and configured player names.
- A running encounter timer.

COMPARE LIKE WITH LIKE

A useful test is one where the context is recorded: level, zone, gear, group composition, encounter length, target type, deaths, target access, and unusual downtime. The meter is best used to track growth and patterns, not to treat one fight as a definitive class ranking.

Thanks and acknowledgments

OPEN-SOURCE SOFTWARE

MnM Party Meter would not be possible without the developers and contributors who build and maintain the open-source software underneath it.

Python	https://www.python.org/
Tesseract OCR	https://github.com/tesseract-ocr/tesseract
PySide6 / Qt for Python	https://www.qt.io/qt-for-python
pytesseract	https://github.com/madmaze/pytesseract
Pillow	https://python-pillow.org/
MSS	https://github.com/BoboTiG/python-mss

COMMUNITY

Thank you to the Monsters & Memories community and to everyone who tests the meter, shares combat examples, reports problems, and helps improve recognition accuracy.

MnM Party Meter is an independent community utility. It is not affiliated with, endorsed by, or an official product of the Monsters & Memories development team.

MORE INFORMATION

Third-party licenses and project links are also listed in `THIRD_PARTY_NOTICES.md` in the source repository.